

QuietTime

User Guide

Version 2.1 • Android & Windows

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1. Welcome

QuietTime is a simple screen time control app designed for families. It lets parents set bedtime schedules that lock the device to a beautiful, calming screen — encouraging healthy screen habits without harsh lockouts.

QuietTime works entirely offline. No accounts, no cloud, no tracking. Everything stays on your device.

Available for **Android** and **Windows**.

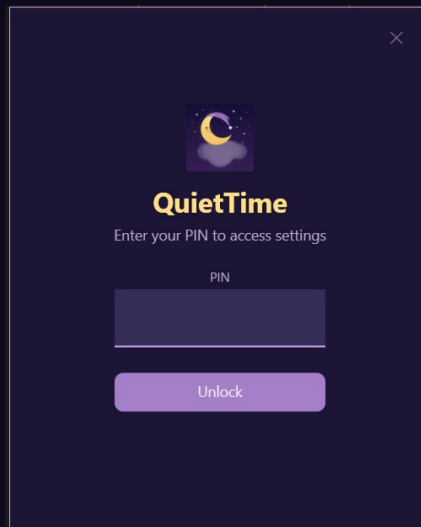
2. Getting Started

Installation

- **Android** — Download from Google Play or install the APK directly.
- **Windows** — Download from the Microsoft Store or from davidarthur.app/quiettime/.

First Launch

When you first open QuietTime, you will be asked to create a 6-digit PIN. This PIN protects all settings and prevents children from changing the schedule or disabling the app.

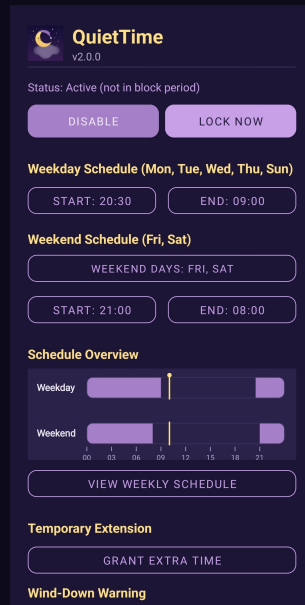


PIN entry screen (Windows)

Tip: Choose a PIN your child cannot guess. You can change it later from Settings.

3. The Dashboard

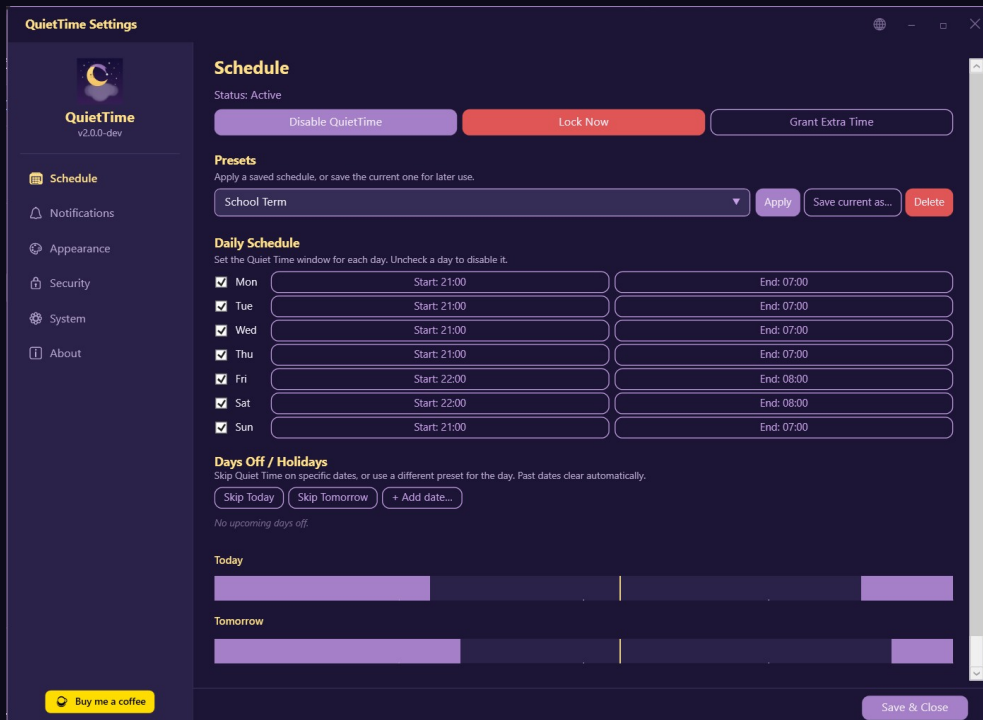
The dashboard is your control centre. From here you can see the current status, set your daily schedule, view the weekly overview, and grant extra time.



Dashboard (Android) — schedule, overview, and extra time

Key controls:

- **Status** — Shows whether QuietTime is active and if a block period is in progress.
- **Enable / Lock Now** — Turn QuietTime on or off, or start the block immediately outside the scheduled time.
- **Daily Schedule** — Set the Quiet Time window for each day of the week individually. Each day has its own start time, end time, and on/off toggle — uncheck a day to skip it entirely.
- **Schedule Timeline** — Visual bars showing today's and tomorrow's blocked periods.
- **View Weekly Schedule** — A 7-day grid showing all blocked hours at a glance.
- **Grant Extra Time** — Give additional minutes during an active block period.



Settings — Schedule (Windows) showing daily times, presets, days off and the timeline preview

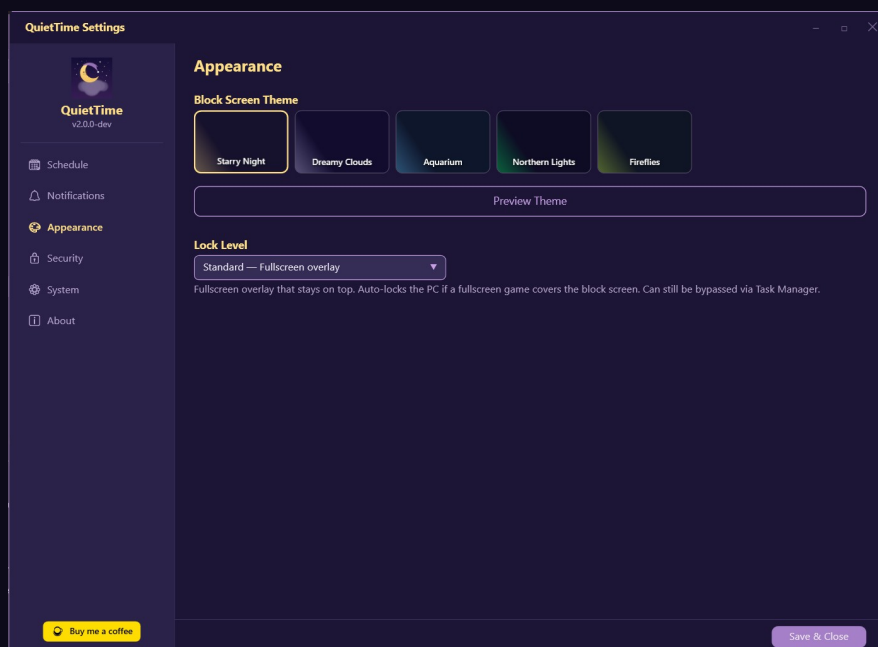
Settings Layout (Windows) — The Windows Settings window is organised into seven sections accessible from the sidebar on the left:

- **Schedule** — Daily schedule, presets, days off, timeline preview, and Extra Time.
- **Notifications** — Wind-down warning and chime sound.
- **Appearance** — Block screen theme and lock level.
- **Security** — Change PIN and change recovery password.
- **System** — Start with Windows.
- **Activity Log** — Summary, filter, history with CSV export.
- **About** — Version, links, and support.

4. Block Screen Themes

When the block period starts, the device shows a full-screen animated theme instead of a harsh lockout message. Nine themes are available:

- **Starry Night** — Twinkling stars with a crescent moon
- **Dreamy Clouds** — Soft, drifting clouds
- **Aquarium** — Underwater scene with gentle movement
- **Northern Lights** — Aurora borealis effect
- **Fireflies** — Warm glowing fireflies in the dark
- **Lava Lamp** — Slow, glowing blobs rising and sinking (*Android, new in 2.1*)
- **Galaxy** — A slowly turning spiral galaxy and a field of stars (*Android, new in 2.1*)
- **Rain on Glass** — Raindrops running down a window past soft, out-of-focus lights (*Android, new in 2.1*)
- **Silk Waves** — Iridescent ribbons folding over one another like satin (*Android, new in 2.1*)

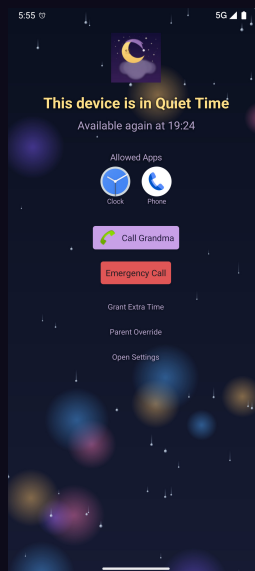


Appearance section — pick a theme and lock level (Windows)

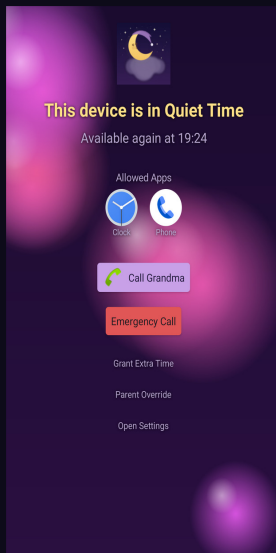
You can preview themes before selecting them from the Settings page.



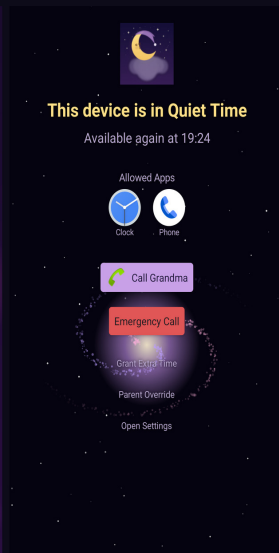
Starry Night block screen (Windows) with parent controls at the bottom



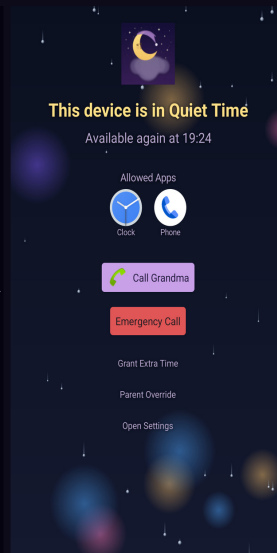
Block screen (Android) with allowed apps, a named emergency contact, and the emergency call button



Lava Lamp



Galaxy



Rain on Glass



Silk Waves

The four themes added in version 2.1 (Android)

5. Allowed Apps

During a block period, certain apps can remain accessible. This is useful for apps like alarm clocks, meditation apps, or emergency contacts.

On **Android**, allowed apps appear as icons on the block screen. Tap one to open it. On **Windows**, allowed apps can bypass the lock overlay.

Tip: Keep the allowed list short. The purpose of QuietTime is to reduce screen time, so only allow apps that are genuinely needed at bedtime.

6. Wind-Down Warnings

QuietTime can show a warning before the block period starts, giving children time to finish what they are doing. You can set the warning to appear 5, 10, 15, or 30 minutes before bedtime.

Once wind-down begins, QuietTime shows a series of system tray notifications counting down to bedtime (at 30, 15, 10, 5, 2 and 1 minute remaining, depending on your warning time).

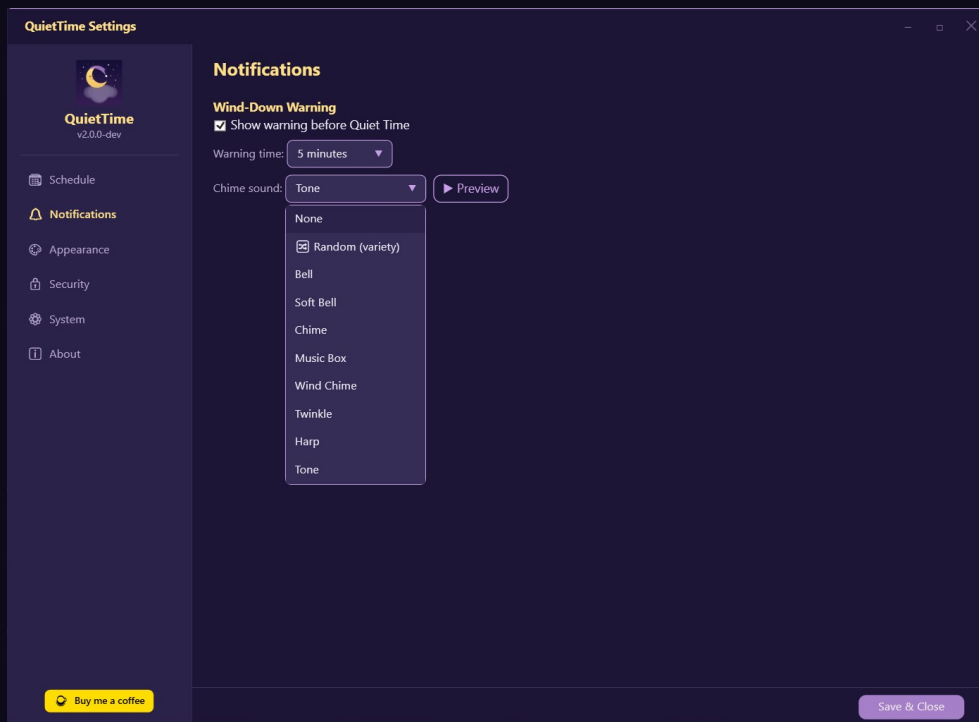
Chime Sounds (Windows)

On Windows, you can choose a chime sound that plays alongside the wind-down notifications. Chimes are intentionally gentle and non-startling. To keep things polite, chimes only play at the start of the wind-down period and again at the 5 and 1 minute marks — not on every notification.

Eight chime sounds are included:

- **Bell** — Classic single bell tone
- **Soft Bell** — Warm, low bell with a longer decay
- **Chime** — Two-note descending doorbell
- **Music Box** — Three rising notes
- **Wind Chime** — Three bell tones with staggered timing
- **Twinkle** — Bright ascending arpeggio
- **Harp** — Gentle descending cascade
- **Tone** — Short, simple beep

Selecting **Random** tells QuietTime to choose a different chime each time, avoiding repeats. Selecting **None** disables chimes entirely while keeping the visual notifications. Use the 'Preview' button in Settings to listen to each chime before choosing.



Notifications section (Windows) — warning time and chime sound, including the Random option

7. Parent Controls

Parents have full control during a block period:

- **Grant Extra Time** — Add 15 minutes, 30 minutes, 1 hour, or 2 hours to the current block.
- **Parent Override** — End the block period early with your PIN.
- **Lock Now** — Start the block immediately, outside the scheduled time.
- **Disable QuietTime** — Turn off scheduling temporarily.

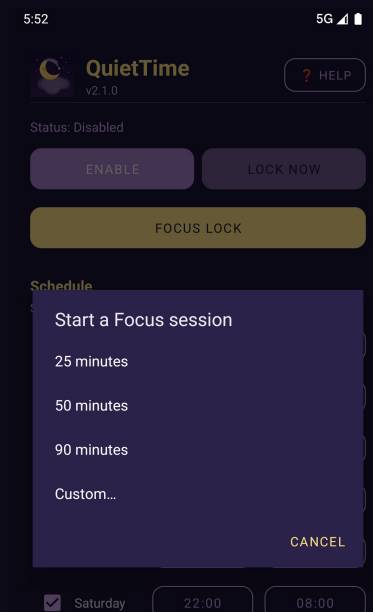
All actions require PIN entry to prevent children from bypassing the controls.

8. Focus Sessions (Android)

A Focus session locks the device straight away for a fixed length of time — useful for homework, revision, or sitting down to a meal. It works independently of the daily schedule, so you can start one at any time of day without editing your bedtime settings.

To start one, tap **Focus Lock** on the dashboard and choose a length:

- **25 minutes** — one short study block
- **50 minutes** — a longer stretch of work
- **90 minutes** — a full homework session
- **Custom** — any length you like



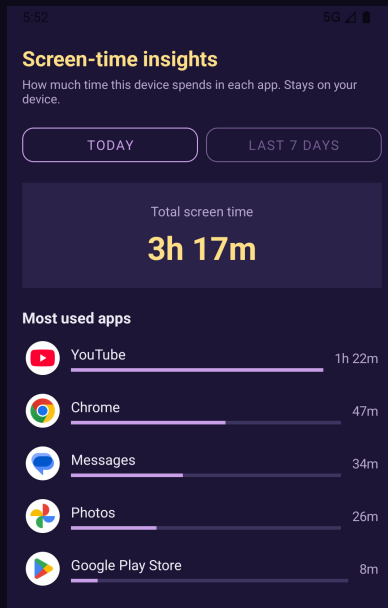
Starting a Focus session from the dashboard (Android)

While a Focus session is running the block screen behaves exactly as it does at bedtime: allowed apps still work, the emergency call button is still there, and a parent can still end the session early with the PIN. The session also survives a reboot, so restarting the device is not a way around it.

Tip: Focus sessions are recorded in the Activity Log, so you can see how much focused time was actually completed.

9. Screen-Time Insights (Android)

Insights show how the device has actually been used: total screen time and the most-used apps, for either today or the last seven days. It turns a conversation about screen time into one about specific numbers rather than impressions.



Screen-Time Insights (Android) — total time and the most-used apps

Android requires you to grant **Usage access** before any app can read these figures. QuietTime asks for it the first time you open Insights and takes you to the right settings screen; until it is granted, the screen stays empty.

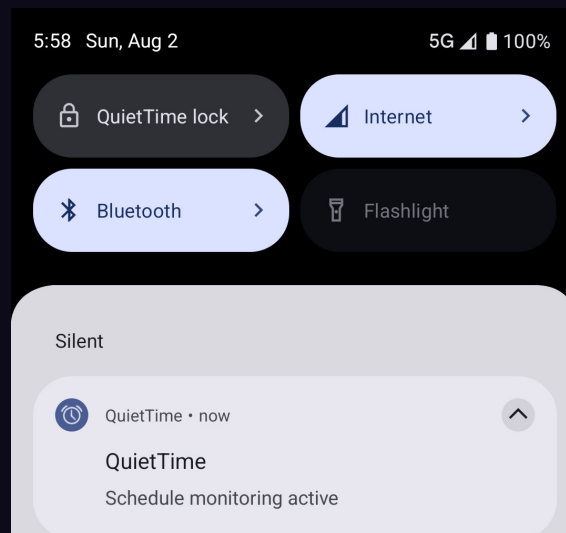
The figures come from Android's own usage statistics, read at the moment you open the screen. QuietTime displays them and nothing more — they are not stored by us, not collected, and never leave the device.

10. Quick Tile & Home-Screen Widget (Android)

Two shortcuts let a parent lock the device without opening the app.

Quick Settings tile

Swipe down twice to open Quick Settings, tap the pencil or 'Edit' button, and drag the **QuietTime** tile into your active tiles. Tapping it starts the block immediately; tapping it again asks for your PIN to end it.



The QuietTime tile in Quick Settings, with the ongoing service notification below

Home-screen widget

Long-press an empty area of the home screen, choose **Widgets**, find QuietTime, and drop the widget where you want it. It shows the current status at a glance and doubles as a one-tap lock.

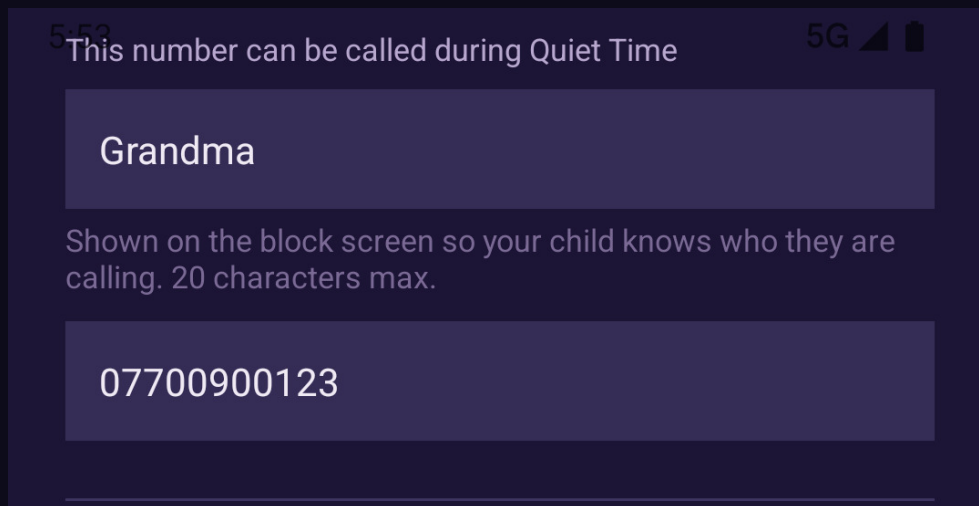
Tip: Both shortcuts only ever start a block without a PIN. Ending one always needs the PIN, so leaving the tile on a child's device is safe.

11. Emergency Access

The emergency call button is always visible on the block screen, even during an active block. Tapping it opens the phone dialler so a genuine emergency number — 999 in the UK, 911 in the US, 112 across the EU, or whatever applies where you are — can always be dialled. This works whether or not you have set up an emergency contact.

Named emergency contact

In Settings you can also add one emergency contact: a phone number and a name. When both are set, a second button appears on the block screen reading, for example, **Call Grandma** — so a child taps a familiar name rather than trying to remember a number. The name is limited to 20 characters so the button stays readable. If no number is set, the button is hidden entirely rather than shown and doing nothing.



Emergency contact name and number in Settings (Android)

Tip: Use a name your child actually uses — 'Mum' or 'Grandma' reads better under pressure than a full name.

12. PIN & Recovery Password

Your 6-digit PIN protects all settings and controls. Without the PIN, children cannot:

- Change the schedule
- Disable QuietTime
- Grant extra time
- Override the block
- Change the PIN

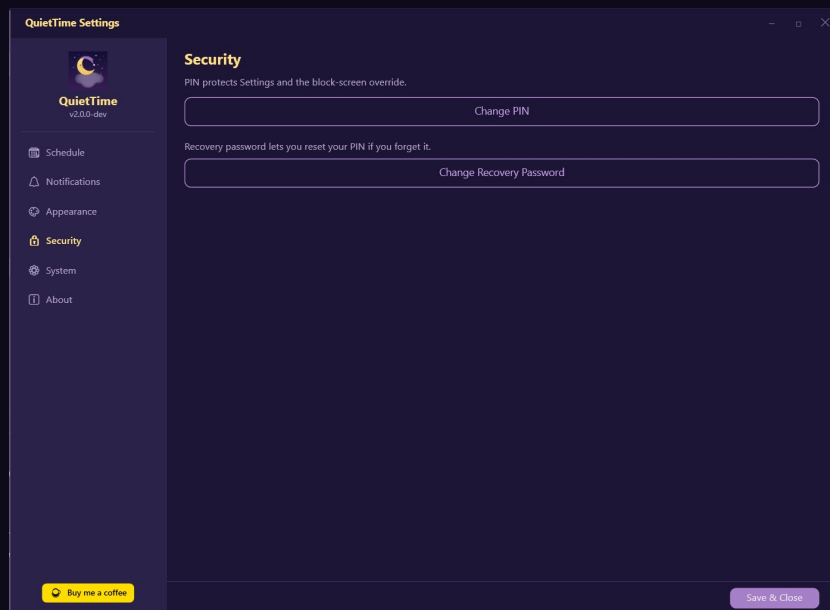
You can change your PIN at any time from the Settings page.

Recovery Password

QuietTime allows you to set a recovery password as a backup. If you forget your PIN, you can use the recovery password to reset it.

If you lose both your PIN and recovery password, the only way to regain access is to clear the app's data or reinstall, which will remove all settings and schedules.

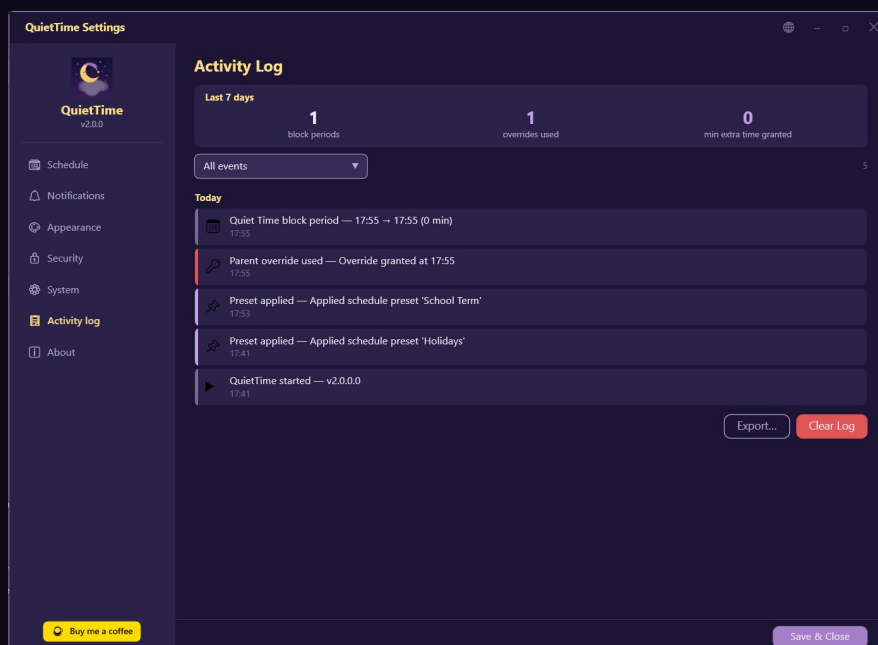
Tip: Write your recovery password down and keep it somewhere safe.



Security section (Windows) — change PIN and change recovery password

13. Activity Log

QuietTime keeps a local activity log on your device so you can review how the app has been used. Open it from the **Activity Log** entry in the Settings sidebar. The log is stored only on your device and is never sent anywhere.



Activity Log (Windows) — 7-day summary, filter, colour-coded entries grouped by day, with Export and PIN-protected Clear

Events recorded:

- Block period start and end times (paired into a single 'block period' row with duration)
- Parent overrides used
- Extra time granted
- Focus sessions started and ended (Android)
- Schedule preset applied, saved, or deleted
- Day off added or removed
- Settings changes
- PIN or recovery password changed
- Lock level, theme, wind-down warning, or language changed
- App started and shut down

Summary card

At the top of the log you see at-a-glance counters for the last 7 days: how many block periods completed, how many overrides were used, and how many minutes of extra time were granted. Overrides and extra time are shown in accent colour so they stand out from routine activity.

Filter

Use the filter dropdown to narrow the list to a single category:

- **All events** — everything
- **Block periods** — routine quiet-time blocks
- **Overrides & extras** — parent overrides and granted extra time
- **Schedule changes** — presets, days off, schedule edits
- **Security changes** — PIN, recovery password, lock level
- **System & app** — theme, wind-down, language, app start/shutdown

Visual cues

Each entry has a coloured stripe on its left edge so you can scan the log quickly:

- **Red** — overrides and extensions (worth knowing about)
- **Gold** — security changes (PIN, recovery, lock level)
- **Purple** — schedule changes
- **Neutral grey** — routine block periods
- **Dim grey** — background system events

Entries are grouped by day with **Today / Yesterday** headers so you can find recent activity at a glance.

Export to CSV

Click **Export...** to save the log as a CSV file (opens in Excel, Numbers, or any spreadsheet app). Useful for sharing with a co-parent, archiving before a clear, or reviewing patterns over a longer period.

Clear log (PIN required)

Clearing the log is destructive and irreversible, so QuietTime asks for your PIN every time — even though you've already entered it to open Settings. This protects the audit trail if you walk away from an open Settings window.

Tip: Export the log to CSV before clearing if you'd like to keep a record.

14. Windows-Specific Features

Lock Level

Windows offers three lock levels to control how strictly the block screen is enforced:

- **Gentle** — Shows the block screen but can be dismissed. Good for older children.
- **Standard** — Fullscreen overlay that requires the PIN to dismiss. Can be bypassed via Task Manager.
- **Strict** — Fullscreen overlay that cannot be bypassed without the PIN. Task Manager is blocked.

Start with Windows

Enable this option to have QuietTime start automatically when the computer boots. This ensures the schedule is always active, even if the child restarts the computer.

15. Privacy

QuietTime is designed with privacy at its core:

- **No accounts** — No sign-up or login required.
- **No cloud** — All data stays on your device. Nothing is sent to any server.
- **No tracking** — No analytics, no usage data, no telemetry.
- **No ads** — No advertisements of any kind.

Screen-Time Insights is the one screen that reads data from outside QuietTime, and it is worth being precise about: the figures come from Android's own usage statistics on the device, are read only at the moment you open the screen, and are shown to you and nothing else. They are not stored by us, not collected, and never leave the device.

For full details, see the Privacy Policy at davidarthur.app/quiettime/privacy/.

16. Troubleshooting & FAQ

Q: Can my child bypass QuietTime?

A: On Android, QuietTime uses device administrator permissions and accessibility services to prevent bypass. On Windows, the Strict lock level blocks Task Manager. No method is 100% foolproof, but QuietTime is designed to make bypassing difficult for children.

Q: What happens during emergencies?

A: The emergency call button is always visible on the block screen and opens the dialler, so a genuine emergency number (999, 911, 112, or whatever applies locally) can always be called — with or without an emergency contact set up. If you have added a contact and a name, a second button appears showing that name, so your child does not need to remember the number. Parents can also override or grant extra time at any moment with their PIN.

Q: Does a Focus session survive a restart?

A: Yes. Restarting the device does not end a Focus session — QuietTime restores it on boot and the block screen comes straight back. The session ends when its time is up, or earlier if a parent ends it with the PIN.

Q: Why does Screen-Time Insights need Usage access?

A: Android does not let any app see how long other apps have been used until you grant Usage access in system settings. QuietTime asks once and takes you to the right screen. Nothing is read until you grant it, and the figures are only ever displayed on your device.

Q: What if I forget my PIN?

A: Use your recovery password to reset it. If you've lost both your PIN and recovery password, you'll need to clear the app's data or reinstall, which will remove all settings and schedules. We recommend writing your recovery password down somewhere safe.

Q: Does QuietTime use battery?

A: QuietTime uses minimal battery. It runs a small background service that checks the schedule. The animated block screen only runs during active block periods.

Q: Can I use different schedules on different days?

A: Yes. From version 2.0 onwards each day of the week has its own start time, end time and on/off toggle, so you can set Monday's bedtime later than Friday's, give Saturday a lie-in, or skip Sunday entirely. You can also save the whole week as a preset (e.g. "School Term" or "Holidays") and switch between them with one click.

QuietTime

Simple screen time control that respects your family's privacy.

davidarthur.app/quiettime/
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